Reasoning shortcuts sheet

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Letters & coding

- A–Z positions: E = 5, J = 10, O = 15, T = 20, Y = 25 **Remember 'EJOTY'.**
- Opposite letter: position of opposite = 27 − position **A ↔ Z, M ↔ N.**
- Reverse position = 27 − forward position

Clocks

- Angle between hands = $|30H - 5.5M|°$ **Take 360 minus it if over 180.**
- Hands coincide every 720/11 = 65 5/11 minutes
- Hands overlap 22 times, are opposite 22 times, and at right angles 44 times in 24 hours

Calendars

- Odd days: ordinary year 1, leap year 2
- Leap year: divisible by 4; century years only if divisible by 400 **1900 no, 2000 yes.**
- Days of the week repeat every 7 days; 100 years have 5 odd days

Ranking & order

- Total = rank from left + rank from right − 1
- People between two ranks (same side) = difference − 1

Directions

- Turning right from North gives East; left gives West
- Shortest distance = $\sqrt{(x^2 + y^2)}$ **Net east-west x, net north-south y.**

Inequalities & syllogisms

- A ≥ B > C ⇒ A > C; A ≥ B ≤ C ⇒ no relation
- Either-or: when two conclusions are complementary and neither alone follows
- All A are B + All B are C ⇒ All A are C
- Some A are B ⇒ Some B are A; 'All A are B' ⇒ 'Some B are A' **Possibility questions: check if it can be true.**